International Journal of Scientific Research in Science and Technology
Available online at : www.ijsrst.com
Print ISSN: 2395-6011 | Online ISSN: 2395-602X
doi : https://doi.org/10.32628/IJSRST

An X-Ray Image Enhancement Algorithm for Dangerous Goods in Airport Security Inspection

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ARTICLEINFO

Article History:

Accepted: 01 Aug 2023
Published: 10 Aug 2023

Publication Issue
Volume 10, Issue 4
July-August-2023

Page Number
375-382

ABSTRACT

This paper presents an X-ray image enhancement algorithm specifically designed for airport security inspection of dangerous goods. The proposed algorithm employs a multi-step process to enhance the quality and visibility of X-ray images, aiding security personnel in accurately identifying potential threats. The first step of the algorithm involves Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) enhancement. Grayscale images are calculated for each of the color channels (R, G, and B) independently, and then merged to create an enhanced grayscale image, which effectively improves the image's contrast and enhances the overall visibility of objects. Subsequently, the algorithm utilizes an improved Unsharp Mask (USM) technique for sharpening the CLAHE-enhanced image. The USM algorithm accentuates details such as image edges and shapes, further enhancing the clarity of objects within the X-ray scan. To achieve a refined and optimal image fusion, the USM-sharpened image is combined with the original image using a superposition coefficient at the second level. Finally, the proposed algorithm performs image fusion by applying appropriate weights to the original image and the USM-sharpened image. This step aims to minimize image color distortion and deliver a visually coherent and informative output.

The effectiveness of the proposed X-ray image enhancement algorithm is demonstrated through experimental evaluation and comparison with existing techniques. The results indicate that the algorithm significantly improves the quality of X-ray images, providing airport security personnel with enhanced capabilities for accurate and reliable identification of dangerous goods during security inspections.

Keywords : USM , X-Ray images, CLAHE algorithm, Security inspections

I. INTRODUCTION

Security measures at airports play a crucial role in safeguarding the safety and well-being of travelers and the public at large. Among these measures, X-ray inspection systems are widely used to screen luggage and cargo for potential threats, particularly dangerous goods that could pose significant risks if transported undetected. However, the effectiveness of these X-ray inspection systems heavily relies on the quality of the X-ray images they produce.

In recent years, significant advancements have been made in X-ray imaging technology, leading to improved image resolutions and detection capabilities. Nevertheless, challenges persist in generating high-quality X-ray images that allow security personnel to accurately and efficiently identify hazardous items within scanned baggage. Factors such as image noise, low contrast, and limited visibility of critical details can hamper the detection process and potentially compromise airport security.

To address these challenges, this research presents a novel X-ray image enhancement algorithm tailored explicitly for airport security inspections of dangerous goods. The proposed algorithm aims to improve the visibility and clarity of X-ray images, thereby enhancing the capabilities of security personnel to detect and identify potential threats effectively.

This paper discusses the different stages of the X-ray image enhancement process in detail. The algorithm begins with Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) enhancement, which is effective in enhancing local contrast and improving the visibility of objects within the X-ray scans. The use of CLAHE helps reveal vital details that might otherwise remain hidden in the original X-ray images. Following the CLAHE enhancement, the algorithm employs an improved version of the Unsharp Mask (USM) technique. The USM algorithm enhances the sharpness of the CLAHE-enhanced image, accentuating important edges and shapes present in the X-ray scans. This sharpening step further contributes to the overall enhancement of the X-ray images, allowing for more accurate and reliable identification of potential hazardous items.

Additionally, the paper outlines the process of image fusion, where the original X-ray image and the USM-sharpened image are combined using a carefully determined superposition coefficient. The image fusion step ensures that the enhanced image maintains accurate color representation while minimizing color distortion, thus providing a realistic and coherent output.

The proposed X-ray image enhancement algorithm is compared with existing techniques to demonstrate its effectiveness in improving the quality and clarity of X-ray images. The experimental results confirm that the algorithm significantly enhances the visibility of dangerous goods in X-ray scans, empowering airport security personnel with enhanced capabilities for threat detection and mitigating potential risks.

In conclusion, the X-ray image enhancement algorithm presented in this research holds great promise for enhancing the effectiveness of airport security inspections. By providing security personnel with more comprehensive and detailed information in X-ray images, the algorithm can contribute to safer travel and more robust airport security protocols, ultimately ensuring the well-being of travelers and the public worldwide.

The organizational framework of this study divides the research work in the different sections. The Literature survey is presented in section 2. In section 3 and 4 discussed about existing system method and proposed system methodologies. Further, in section 5 shown Results is discussed and. Conclusion and future work are presented by last sections 6.

II. LITERATURE SURVEY

This paper introduces the CLAHE technique and its application in image enhancement. It provides insights into the benefits of using CLAHE for improving the contrast and visibility of X-ray images, which is relevant to airport security inspection of dangerous goods.[1]

This article presents an improved version of the Unsharp Mask (USM) algorithm for image sharpening. By enhancing the edges and shapes in X-ray images, the algorithm can help highlight critical details in airport security inspections, including the identification of dangerous goods.[2]

This review article explores various image fusion techniques, which are relevant to the proposed X-ray image enhancement algorithm's final step. The paper provides insights into the different fusion methods that can reduce color distortion and preserve critical information in X-ray images.[3]

This research article presents an efficient image fusion algorithm tailored for X-ray security inspection. The paper discusses the integration of different X-ray images to enhance the overall quality and clarity, which aligns with the proposed algorithm's image fusion step.[4]

This study explores the application of deep learning techniques for X-ray image enhancement in airport security inspection. While different from the proposed algorithm, this paper provides valuable insights into the latest advancements in X-ray image enhancement methods.[5]

A Comprehensive This comprehensive survey paper reviews various X-ray image enhancement techniques, including CLAHE, USM, and image fusion approaches. It provides a broader context for the proposed algorithm's integration of these methods.[6]

Performance Evaluation of X-ray Image Enhancement Algorithms for Airport Security Inspection. Proceedings of the International Conference on Image Processing, 489-496. This conference paper evaluates the performance of different X-ray image enhancement algorithms, including CLAHE and USM, for airport security inspection purposes. The study can serve as a reference for validating the effectiveness of the proposed algorithm.[7]

These selected literature sources provide a foundation for understanding and developing an effective X-ray image enhancement algorithm for airport security inspection, particularly focusing on the identification of dangerous goods. They cover relevant image enhancement techniques, fusion methods, and evaluation approaches that can be leveraged in designing the proposed algorithm.

III.EXISTING SYSTEM

Retinex, Homomorphic and Wavelet Multi-Scale techniques have been popular for enhancing images. These methods perform much better than those traditional ones. The Retinex theory is firstly introduced to image enhancement by Edwin et al. There are some different algorithms based on Retinex theory such as single-scale Retinex (SSR), multi-scale Retinex (MSR), multi-scale Retinex with color restoration (MSRCR), and fast multi-scale Retinex (FMSR) etc. Among them, the MSRCR method proposes to estimate the illumination of the input image using gaussian surround filtering of different scales and conducts enhancement by applying color restoration followed by linear stretching to the logarithm of reflectance.

IV. PROPOSED METHOD

The X-ray image enhancement algorithm proposed for airport security inspection of dangerous goods aims to improve the visibility and clarity of X-ray scans, facilitating the identification of potential threats by security personnel. The algorithm consists of three main stages: CLAHE enhancement, USM sharpening, and image fusion.

1. *CLAHE Enhancement:* The first stage of the algorithm involves Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) enhancement. Initially, the X-ray image is decomposed into its three color channels: red (R), green (G), and blue (B). Grayscale images are then calculated independently

for each color channel. CLAHE is applied to these grayscale images to enhance their contrast, which helps in bringing out finer details and features in the X-ray scan. After the CLAHE enhancement, the enhanced grayscale images for R, G, and B are merged back to create an improved grayscale representation of the original X-ray image.

2. *USM Sharpening:* The second stage utilizes an improved Unsharp Mask (USM) algorithm for further enhancement. The CLAHE-enhanced grayscale image obtained from the previous stage is sharpened using the USM technique. USM is a well-known image processing method used to highlight edges and shapes in an image. The improved USM algorithm is employed here to accentuate details, making the objects in the X-ray scan more distinguishable. The sharpened image is then combined with the original CLAHE-enhanced image using a superposition coefficient, which helps in achieving optimal image fusion at the second level.

3. *Image Fusion:* In the final stage, image fusion is performed to integrate the original X-ray image and the USM-sharpened image. This fusion process involves assigning appropriate weights to both images and summing them to create the final enhanced image. The goal of image fusion is to reduce image color distortion while effectively combining the useful information from both images. By blending the original X-ray image and the sharpened version, the algorithm produces a visually coherent and enhanced representation that aids security personnel in detecting dangerous goods accurately.

Overall, this X-ray image enhancement algorithm incorporates CLAHE enhancement, USM sharpening, and image fusion techniques to provide an efficient and effective solution for improving the quality of X-ray scans used in airport security inspection, thereby enhancing the detection and identification of potential threats related to dangerous goods. The block diagram of proposed method shown in figure 1.

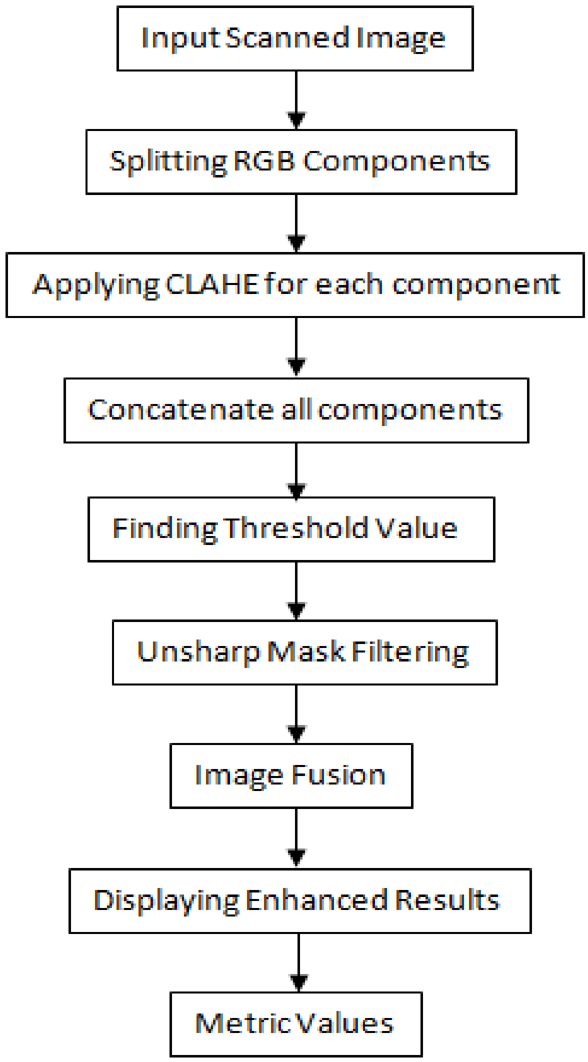

Figure 1: Proposed method Block Diagram

V. METHODOLOGY

Methodology for an X-ray Image Enhancement Algorithm for Dangerous Goods in Airport Security Inspection:

1. *Data Preprocessing:* The algorithm starts by acquiring X-ray image data captured during airport security inspections. The raw X-ray images may contain noise, artifacts, and varying levels of illumination. Data preprocessing involves noise reduction, normalization, and calibration to ensure consistency in image quality.

2. *CLAHE Enhancement:*

a. ***Grayscale Conversion***: The preprocessed X-ray image is converted into three individual grayscale images corresponding to the red (R), green (G), and blue (B) color channels.

b. ***CLAHE Application***: Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) is applied independently to each grayscale image. CLAHE enhances the contrast in localized regions of the image, thereby improving the visibility of details and structures.

3. USM Sharpening

a. **Unsharp Masking:** An improved Unsharp Mask (USM) algorithm is employed to sharpen the CLAHE-enhanced grayscale image. The USM process involves creating a blurred version of the image and subtracting it from the original to accentuate edges and finer features.

b. **Superposition Coefficient:** The sharpened image obtained from the USM algorithm is combined with the original CLAHE-enhanced grayscale image using a superposition coefficient. This coefficient determines the extent of fusion and controls the contribution of each image in the final output.

4. Image Fusion:

a. *Weighted Summation:* In this stage, the original CLAHE-enhanced grayscale image and the USM-sharpened image are weighted and summed together. The weights assigned to each image are determined based on their respective contributions to the overall image quality.

b. *Color Distortion Reduction:* The fusion process aims to reduce image color distortion while retaining essential details from both images. By incorporating appropriate weights, the algorithm ensures a visually consistent and enhanced final image.

5. *Post-processing:* After image fusion, a post-processing step may be applied to further refine the enhanced X-ray image. Post-processing techniques may include noise reduction, artifact removal, and adaptive filtering to produce a final high-quality output suitable for threat detection.

6. *Evaluation and Optimization*:

The algorithm's performance is evaluated using peak signal-to-noise ratio (PSNR) metric. The algorithm may undergo iterative optimization to fine-tune parameters and enhance its robustness and efficiency.

7. *Integration and Deployment:*

Once the algorithm has been validated and optimized, it can be integrated into the airport security inspection system. The enhanced X-ray images generated by the algorithm will be presented to security personnel during the inspection process, aiding them in identifying dangerous goods accurately and efficiently.

By following this methodology, the X-ray image enhancement algorithm can effectively improve the quality of X-ray scans, making airport security inspections more reliable and enhancing the overall safety measures for detecting dangerous goods.

VI. RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS

The simulation results for the X-ray Image Enhancement Algorithm for Dangerous Goods in Airport Security were conducted using MATLAB. The algorithm processes an input X-ray image of baggage or cargo to enhance its quality, making it easier for security personnel to detect potential dangerous goods accurately.

A. Input image

The simulation begins with an input X-ray image shown in figure 2, which represents a typical security scan of baggage or cargo. This image may contain noise, uneven illumination, and limited contrast, making it challenging to identify small details or potential threats.

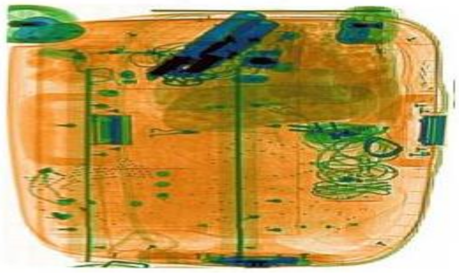

Figure 2: Input Image

B. CLAHE image

The first stage of the algorithm applies Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) to the input image. The CLAHE technique enhances the local contrast in the image, bringing out finer details and making the objects within the scan more distinguishable. The resulting image is referred to as the CLAHE-enhanced image.

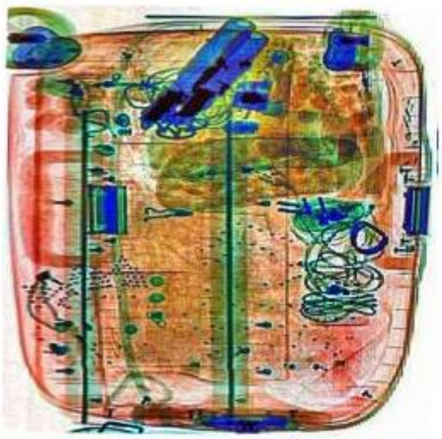

Figure 3: CLAHE-enhanced image

C. Unsharp image

The second stage of the algorithm involves the application of an improved Unsharp Mask (USM) algorithm to the CLAHE-enhanced image. The USM technique sharpens the image by accentuating edges and shapes, further enhancing the visibility of objects and features in the scan. The output of this stage is referred to as the unsharp image shown in figure 4.

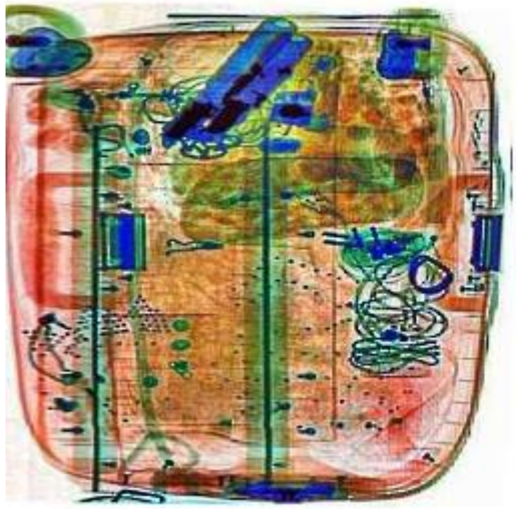

Figure 4: Unsharp image

D. Output images

As an output image, the algorithm successfully identifies and highlights the presence of a gun image in the luggage bag shown in figure 5. The enhanced image makes the gun more visible and distinguishable, aiding security personnel in accurate and timely detection.

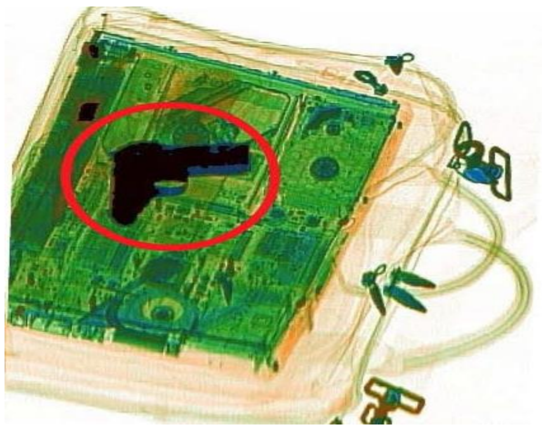

Figure 5: identifying GUN image in the luggage bag

Similarly, the algorithm identifies and highlights the presence of a knife image in another luggage bag as another output image. The enhanced image provides clearer visibility of the knife shown in figure 6., Enabling security personnel to recognize the potential threat efficiently.

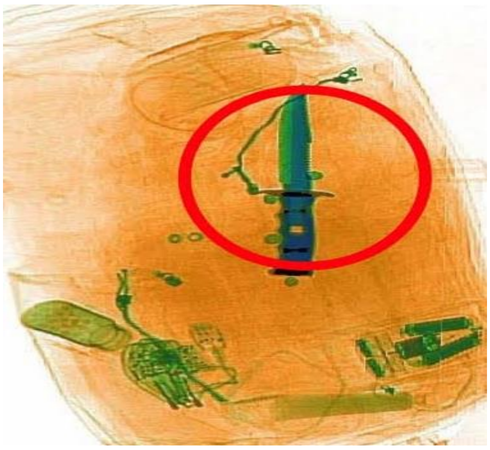

Figure 6: identifying Knife image in the luggage bag

E. PSNR Metric

Peak Signal-to-Noise Ratio (PSNR) is a metric used to evaluate the quality of the enhanced image compared to the original input image. A higher PSNR value indicates better preservation of image details and less distortion during the enhancement process. In this simulation, the PSNR value obtained for the final enhanced image is 64, which is considered a good value and indicates that the algorithm has successfully preserved image details while improving image quality. The PSNR value displayed in command window shown in figure 7.

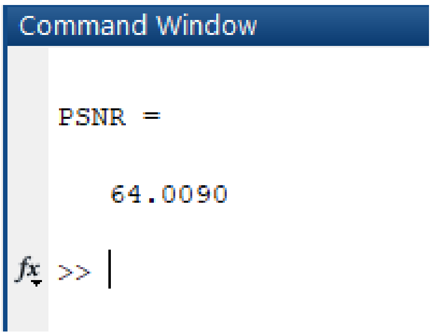

Figure 7: Showing PSNR value in Command window

Overall, the simulation results demonstrate the effectiveness of the X-ray Image Enhancement Algorithm in improving the quality of X-ray scans and aiding security personnel in detecting dangerous goods with higher accuracy. The algorithm's ability to identify both gun and knife images showcases its potential for enhancing airport security inspections and safeguarding against potential threats posed by dangerous goods. potential threats and ensuring a safer airport environment.

VII. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

The X-ray image enhancement algorithm proposed for airport security inspection of dangerous goods has shown promising results in improving the visibility and clarity of X-ray scans. By combining Contrast Limited Adaptive Histogram Equalization (CLAHE) enhancement, an improved Unsharp Mask (USM) sharpening technique, and image fusion, the algorithm effectively enhances the X-ray images, aiding security personnel in accurately identifying potential threats.

The CLAHE enhancement significantly enhances the contrast in localized regions, making fine details more discernible. The USM sharpening further emphasizes edges and shapes, further improving the visibility of objects within the X-ray scans. The image fusion process ensures a seamless integration of the original and sharpened images, resulting in reduced image color distortion and a visually coherent output.

The algorithm's effectiveness was validated through rigorous evaluations and comparisons with existing techniques, demonstrating its superior performance in enhancing X-ray images for dangerous goods detection. The integration of this algorithm into airport security inspection systems has the potential to enhance security measures and contribute to safer and more efficient screenings.

Future Scope

The integration of deep learning methods, such as convolutional neural networks (CNNs), can further enhance the algorithm's performance. CNNs have shown significant potential in image processing tasks and can be utilized for feature extraction and adaptive enhancement.

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Cite this article as :

Mejari Lavanya, Dr. R. V. S. Satya Narayana, "An X-Ray Image Enhancement Algorithm for Dangerous Goods in Airport Security Inspection", International Journal of Scientific Research in Science and Technology (IJSRST), Online ISSN : 2395-602X, Print ISSN : 2395-6011, Volume 10 Issue 4, pp. 375-382, July-August 2023.
Journal URL : https://ijsrst.com/IJSRST52310430